

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Central Asian political field

TIMURID FRAGMENTATION -> rival princes compete for Samarqand/Herat prestige

SHAYBANI UZBEKS -> consolidate Transoxiana and defeat scattered claimants

SAFAVID IRAN -> temporary opening after Merv plus khutba/sikka conditions

OTTOMAN CHALDIRAN -> changes regional balance, not a direct India switch

BABUR -> Farghana loss + Samarqand cycles -> Kabul 1504

QANDAHAR + KABUL -> rear, trade and recruitment before Punjab

RULE: narrowed options plus choice; Central Asia did not predetermine conquest.

MUST REMEMBER: Babur's route runs from Farghana (1494) through Kabul (1504) to Panipat, Khanwa and Ghagra (1526-29).

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Babur chronology 1494-1530

1494 Farghana -> 1497 / 1501 Samarqand captures and losses

1504 Kabul -> 1510 Merv opening -> 1514 Chaldiran context

1519-20 Bhira and Sialkot -> November 1525 final march

1526 Panipat -> 1527 Khanwa -> 1528 Chanderi -> 1529 Ghagra

30 December 1530 -> Babur dies at Agra

MEMORY: Central Asian constraint -> Indian opening -> staged consolidation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Layered identity and legitimacy

PATERNAL CLAIM -> Timur | MATERNAL CLAIM -> Chagatai-Chingizid line

LANGUAGE -> Chagatai Turkic | COURT CULTURE -> Persianate

BARLAS / MONGOL TRADITIONS -> mixed Central Asian political inheritance

MUGHAL -> later Indian dynastic umbrella, not one biological ethnicity

LEGITIMACY -> genealogy + padshah + khutba/sikka + victory + grants

BEGS -> service through kinship, honour, reward and bargaining

CAUTION: genealogy is remembered political capital, not a DNA certificate.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Samarqand cycle: prestige versus resources

SAMARQAND -> Timurid legitimacy + affluent strategic centre

CAPTURE -> symbolic success

SUPPLY + MONEY + HINTERLAND + FOLLOWER LOYALTY -> insufficient

UZBEK PRESSURE + unstable coalitions -> repeated loss

LEARNING -> manoeuvre, resource discipline and limits of city possession

OUTCOME -> Central Asian failure redirects rather than predestines policy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Kabul-Qandahar strategic bridge

KABUL 1504 -> refuge + court/army base + route junction

RESOURCES -> useful but insufficient for expanding begs and warfare

TRADE -> Hindustan + Khurasan + Transoxiana + horses/fruits/textiles

QANDAHAR -> rear/flank security and Iran-Central Asia-Hindustan gate

CULTURE -> Chagatai/Persianate poetry + gardens + recruitment

PUNJAB -> repeated campaigns create an eastern political option

VERDICT: strategic bridge, not merely a poor mountain refuge.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Punjab and the Lodi opening

1519 -> Bajaur/Bhera-Bhira probes and frontier coercion

1519-24 -> repeated Punjab advances, Sialkot/Lahore-Dipalpur contexts

DAULAT KHAN -> invitation, resistance and surrender; not a stable ally

ALAM KHAN -> rival Lodi claimant backed conditionally by Babur

RANA SANGA -> negotiations known mainly through Babur's later accusation

1525 -> final march after rear/flank preparation

RULE: invitations created opportunity but did not cancel Babur's aggression.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Final march and Panipat frontage

NOVEMBER 1525 -> Babur leaves Kabul after securing rear and flank

- > Punjab movement and communication control
- > narrow prepared frontage at Panipat
- > carts linked by raw-hide ropes + breastworks + firing positions
- > gaps retained for cavalry action

TRAP: not a straight unprepared ride from Kabul to one battle.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Panipat combined-arms system

FRONT -> araba carts + raw-hide links + breastworks + cavalry gaps
RIGHT -> Panipat settlement | LEFT -> ditch/obstacles
FIRE -> Ustad Ali/Mustafa + field guns + matchlockmen
MOBILITY -> mounted archery + reserves + reconnaissance
TULUGHMA -> wheeling flank groups strike sides/rear
OUTCOME -> command + frontage + timing + opponent decisions + contingency
CAUTION: guns and memoir army totals do not explain victory alone.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: After Panipat: decision to stay

PANIPAT -> Delhi-Agra centre opens

BUT -> forts resist + Afghans remain + begs dislike India + supplies strain

BABUR DISTRIBUTES WEALTH + appeals to followers + chooses settlement

INDIAN RESOURCES -> support a new political base

RESULT -> invasion begins to become state formation

LIMIT -> Humayun and the Sur interregnum expose continuing fragility.

ASCH MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Panipat-Khanwa-Ghagra ladder

1526 PANIPAT -> Lodi field army defeated; Delhi-Agra opened, control fragile

1527 KHANWA -> Rajput-Afghan coalition + revised field works + rhetoric

1528 CHANDERI -> Medini Rai/strategic follow-through, not all Rajputs

1529 GHAGHRA -> eastern Afghans + Bengal/Nusrat Shah; no Bengal annexation

FOLLOW-UP -> begs + garrisons + forts + revenue + local personnel

1530 -> Babur dies; Humayun succession belongs to Topic 13

VERDICT: conquest ladder created a fragile project, not a completed empire.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Central Asian constraint, Indian political openings and Babur's choices together explain conquest and settlement.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Baburnama and heritage source method

ORIGINAL -> Chagatai Turkish memoir written over time with gaps

CONTENT -> campaigns + court + emotion + landscape + flora/fauna + custom

SELF-FASHIONING -> justification, defeat, loyalty, piety and kingship

TRANSMISSION -> manuscripts + Persian translation under Akbar/Abd al-Rahim

CHECK -> Persian/Afghan/Rajput accounts + coins + inscriptions + material space

BAGH-E BABUR -> multiple Mughal/later phases and modern reconstruction

RULE: vivid eyewitness detail is valuable but never a neutral daily diary.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: The Baburnama is unusually proximate first-person evidence, but self-fashioning and transmission limit neutrality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 12 answer spine

SOURCE -> Baburnama passage + date/genre/transmission + corroboration

IDENTITY -> Timurid-Chagatai-Turkic-Persianate legitimacy

MAP -> Farghana/Samarqand -> Kabul/Qandahar -> Punjab -> Delhi-Agra/east

BATTLE -> frontage + carts/fire + cavalry/tulughma + logistics/contingency

STATE -> begs/grants/garrisons/revenue/local continuity + resistance

CULTURE -> gardens + Chagatai poetry + landscape/natural history + piety

VERDICT -> conqueror and fragile dynastic founder, not complete consolidator.